

Project Report

Guidelines for the Creation of a Project Report

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DEFINITION AND OBJECTIVE

The project report examination is an academic paper where students present their independent processing of a project or practical task and reflect on it based on theoretical approaches and models. The paper covers the objective, planning, exact procedure, and the result of the project.

The main difference between a traditional research essay or written assignment and this assignment is the practical aspect. The project or practical part must be completed before the project report. The project report enables students to showcase their proficiency in applying theoretical approaches to solve practical problems, analyzing, and reflecting on their practical experience using theoretical concepts, and drawing conclusions for their future professional activities.

The project report as an examination format combines both expertise and its practical application through the handling of a specific problem in a practical field. Depending on the course, program, or personal situation, this can be a professional, social, or private environment.

The outcome of a project report is always a 'product' in a literal or figurative sense. This can be physical, such as an engineering model, or conceptual, such as a software solution, installation, intervention, or process.

The project report should provide complete, precise, and comprehensible information about the work or development steps and the approach taken. The project report is a comprehensive record of the project management process, including intermediate steps and products. It should reflect on the approach and methodology used and consider the necessary and available resources. Part of the project report is the acquisition of resources needed for implementation. These resources may include data, surveys, applications, technical equipment, software, and various tools. The final product must also be appropriately documented. If needed, simulate and provide examples of typical application scenarios.

STRUCTURE AND COMPONENTS OF A PROJECT REPORT

To develop a 'product' for a project report, a multi-step process is required. This process is reflected in various chapters and subchapters of the report, following the structure presented below. Deviations from this structure are possible depending on the project's focus and framework. Therefore, it is not necessary to strictly adhere to this structure. Instead, adapt it appropriately to the specific procedure in each case. A suitable structure for the project report can be achieved by focusing on key questions that have served as a framework during the project. The project report is then largely created by answering these key questions in continuous text with (sub)headings.

The definition of the structure in meaningful chapters, subchapters, units and sections can vary depending on the project and is part of the task to be completed in this module.

Introduction: Project objectives and preparations

The introduction should clearly define the problem, analyze the initial conditions, and establish the project's objectives. It should briefly present the project idea by describing the problem and objective(s), and if necessary, provide context for the project environment and initial motivation. This section should comprise approximately 10 to 15% of the report.

The introduction should provide a brief explanation of the approach to solving the problem, including a summary of the individual chapters. Additionally, it should describe the preliminary planning and procedure. To guide the introductory section, consider the following key questions:

- What and how is/was the environment? What is/was the situation? What is the task or issue/problem?"
- What was the objective of the project?
- What procedures were planned and why? Which methodology and tools were chosen based on which theoretical approaches or models?
- What preparatory work, such as data collection, analysis, or material evaluation, was necessary?
- What is the structure of the project report?

Main body: Implementation, evaluation and reflection

The main part of the report should describe the actual implementation, including milestones and any difficulties that may have arisen during the project. All development steps must be recorded in the project report, including interim results. Another requirement is to work on the project or practical task efficiently and with the resources provided, which may be limited. Evaluate the final outcome for effectiveness and benefit. In addition, it is important to consider and evaluate the potential for sustainable integration into daily life. The main section of the report should make up approximately 70 to 80% of the content.

The implementation can be described using the following keywords:

- Persons/roles involved, other stakeholders if applicable
- Risk analysis, if applicable
- Main tasks include phase planning and project phases, as well as process planning and scheduling
- Resources: resource/cost planning
- Progress
- Goal achievement: What result have I achieved? Does it align with the objective of the work? If not, what are the reasons?
- What effects and changes were achieved and measured as a result of the introduction/implementation?
- What conclusions can be drawn from the process? Are there any areas that require improvement?
- What changes and continuous improvements should be implemented?
- How can sustainable structures be created to anchor the findings/results?
- Reflect on performance and dates, if applicable
- Reflect on resources and costs, as well as on the individuals and experts involved, if applicable
- Consider how your practical experience should be assessed in light of theoretical approaches and models

Conclusion: Final remarks

The conclusion should provide a final overall impression and draw conclusions from the aspects of reflection. It should comprise around 10 to 15% of the report. Concluding questions may include:

- What conclusions can be drawn from the results and findings presented in the main section?
- How do these findings relate to your future studies as well as personal and professional development?
- ...

Components of the Project Report

The project report typically consists of the following parts, listed in the table of contents (except for title page and table of contents):

- Title page
- Table of contents (structure)
- List of figures and/or tables
- List of abbreviations
- Text part with introduction, main part, conclusion
- Reference list
- List of appendices
- Appendices and materials

FORMAL GUIDELINES AND REQUIREMENTS

When writing the project report, it is essential to use a factual and precise style with exact wording and scientific terms. The use of first-person perspective should be avoided in project reports. Instead, the writer should use third-person perspective; for example, 'The project group considered the following findings to be particularly valuable...'. When using literature, it must be cited according to the guidelines. Experiential style, colloquial language, embellishments and long, convoluted sentences must be avoided.

The following provides an overview of the key formal requirements and additional documents.

Length BACHELOR	7–10 pages of text
Length MASTER	12–15 pages of text
Formalities	Please refer to the Guidelines for Structuring and Formatting Academic Papers at IU International University in myCampus.
Citation standard	Please refer to the citation guidelines in myCampus.
Reference list	Please refer to the citation guidelines in myCampus.
Affidavit	This pledge must be submitted electronically (via myCampus) before you can submit your assignment.

EVALUATION

The evaluation criteria and their corresponding weight are listed below. **The following explanations of the evaluation criteria can be explained in the task in chapter 2 or specified differently.**

Evaluation criteria	Explanation	Weight
Transfer	Appropriate transfer of theories/models, conclusions in the final remarks	15%
Documentation	Quality of the written work, adherence to formal criteria, accurate spelling and punctuation, good linguistic expression	10%
Resources	Selection and use of appropriate tools, efficient use of resources	10%
Process	Coherence and suitability of the approach	25%
Creativity	Creativity in the approach, methodology, and conclusions drawn from experiences/results	15%
Quality	Depth, thoroughness, and comprehensibility of the reflection on the approach and results, comprehensibility and coherence of the argumentation and findings, appropriate application of theoretical approaches and concepts	25%

Good luck with your Project Report!